

THE MESSAGE

A letter from one who finally woke up

They can shut down websites. Kill apps. Quiet accounts. Throttle the signal. They can't take down this piece of paper. So this is on paper — in someone's hands, off their hands.

WHAT THEY'RE SELLING YOU

Nobody tells you this, because "free" is the sweetest bait there is:

- Your **free app** is a product. *You* are the raw material.
- Your phone is not a phone. It's a **tracking device with a camera**, handed out free — because free is how they get the price paid.
- Your **free cloud** is a lockbox: their server, their lock, your keys in their pocket.
- The police don't need a warrant to trace your month. The companies tracking you sell that — with or without a court asking.
- Our freedoms weren't repealed in a coup. They were **bypassed, one data purchase at a time**.
- And it's no longer just your phone. Cameras on street poles photograph your car **six to twelve times every time you drive past**, and every image goes over the cellular network into one national record. One camera is a moment. The network reconstructs your life — where you work, where you live, who you're seen with — *after the fact*, not just in real time.

All of this is already true, and it's already written in the contracts you signed in a scrolling font too small to read. You never finished reading them — because finishing means admitting what it costs.

CHECK IT YOURSELF — THIS MONTH

I don't ask for your trust. I ask for your curiosity. Three things:

- ❶ **LOOK.** Read one Terms of Service, start to finish. Count every "you hereby grant." That's the receipt.
- ❷ **OWN.** Copy your files to storage you bought and keep — not their cloud. In your house, in your hand.
- ❸ **PASS.** Give one person this page. When they ask why, *this* is the answer.

That's the whole beginning. The rest is logistics.

HOW I GOT HERE

Full of life, once — then quietly crushed, the slow way: ten years of being told to be grateful for the rope.

Then I saw it. And for the last decade I've been pulling myself out, brick by brick. My files live in my house. Their ads and trackers don't follow me home. Even my thinking — even the AI I talk to and the answers I get — runs on machines I paid for with my own hands, in a room you can walk into.

It was never rebellion for its own sake. It was the only honest answer left to one question: **who owns this?**

WHY NOW

It wasn't one day. It was the accumulation.

My privacy, which used to belong to me, is now something they harvest. My speech, which used to be mine to say, is now something they moderate and ration to who profits from me. My data isn't "collected" — it's *sold* — and the people who buy it include the ones who are supposed to answer to a court before they come into my life. They don't need a warrant. They have a data vendor.

And they're still adding pieces. Cameras on more corners. Every pass logged. And the record is wrong sometimes — not harmless, wrong: one bad plate match once had armed officers surround a couple in a parking lot, mistaking their car for a reported stolen one. Every year, bolder — because nobody's stopping them, and nobody is stopping them because **nobody is looking**.

That's why I'm printing this. Everything else they can throttle, switch off, or bury behind a login. This paper doesn't log in.

Free means no one else holds the switch. Paper can't be turned off.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

Not fear. Fear makes people reach for their phones again.

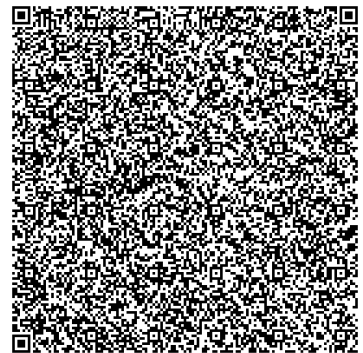
Not a conspiracy. This is a **receipt** — every claim above is true, checkable, and already in the fine print.

Not a command to become me. I'm not asking you to agree with all of this. I'm asking you to **start looking**.

Curiosity is the first act of freedom.

COPY THIS PAGE. HAND IT ON.

Papers fly where signals die.



SCAN IT — IT'S THE WHOLE MESSAGE

— one who woke up